

HELLO!!

1. Please, don't take pictures of my slides:)

(the presentation is on github)

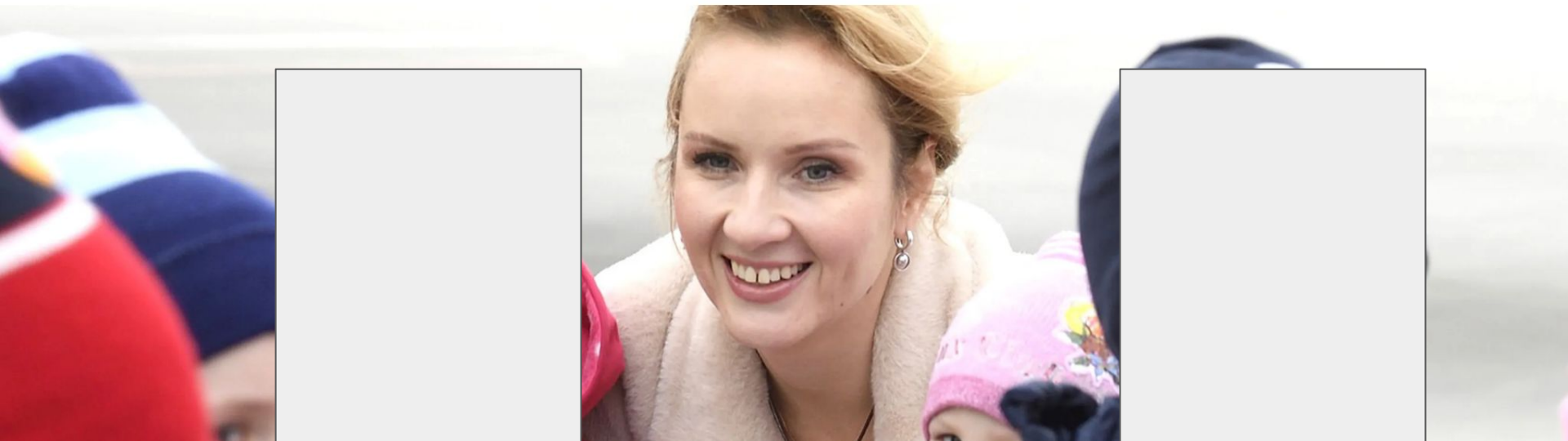
2. Drink some water!

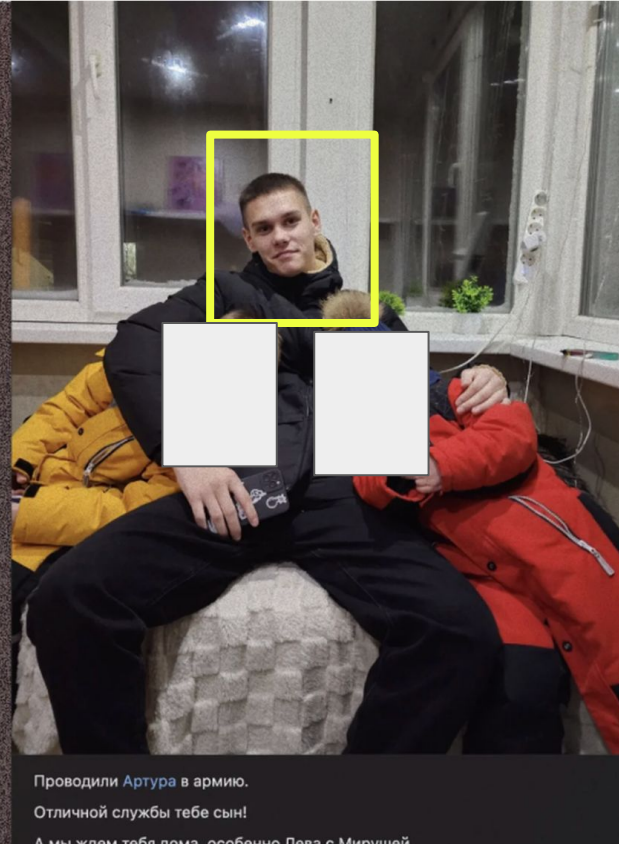
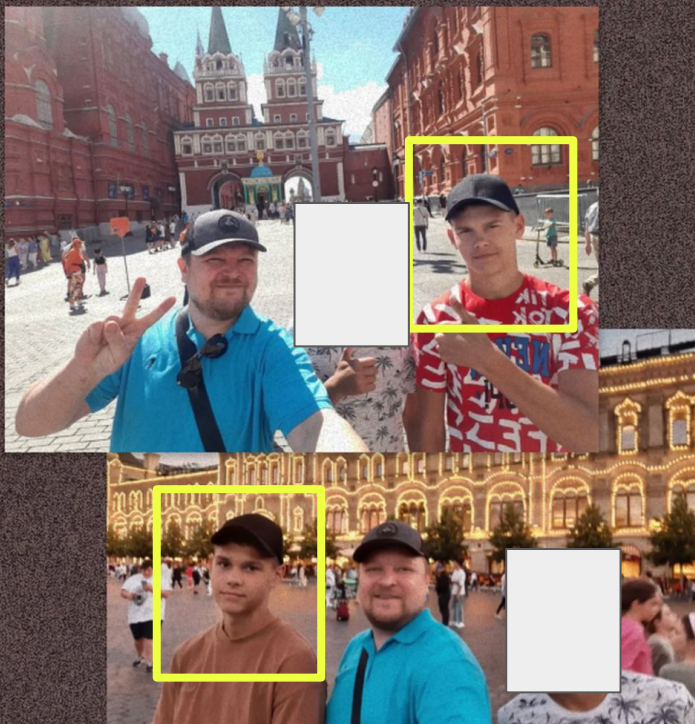
Lost in Russia

Important Stories journalist Katya Bonch-Osmolovskaya discusses how children taken from Ukraine became the basis for an arrest warrant for Putin and were then forgotten.

DATE
MARCH 28, 2025

AUTHOR
KATYA BONCH-OSMOLOVSKAYA





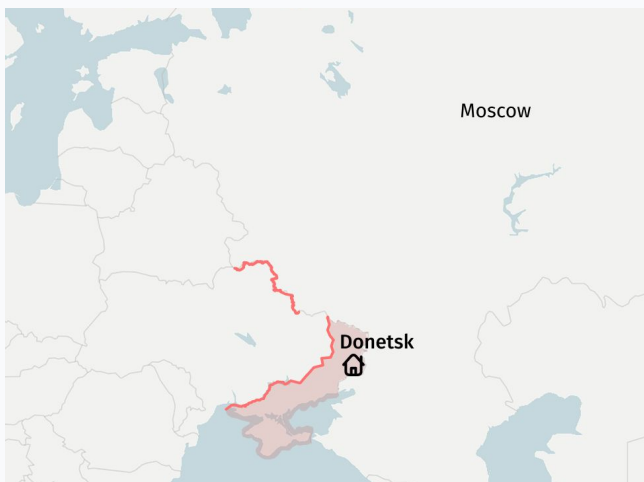
Проводили Артура в армию.

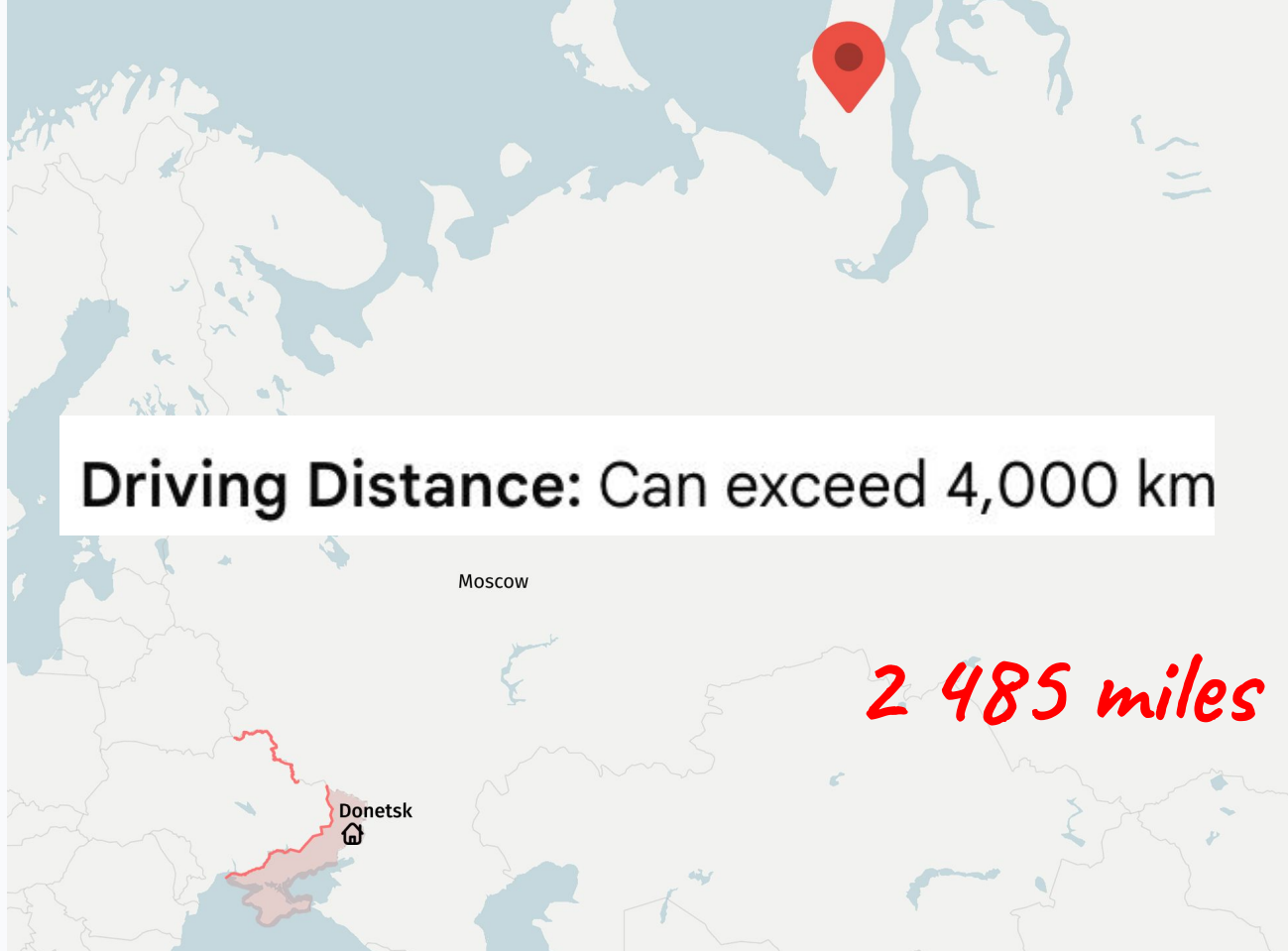
Отличной службы тебе сын!

А мы ждем тебя дома, особенно Лева с Миршей

Artur Zaitsev is taken to a foster family in Yamal (summer 2022) and drafted into the army (December 2024)

PHOTO: OLGA DRUZHININA'S VK PAGE







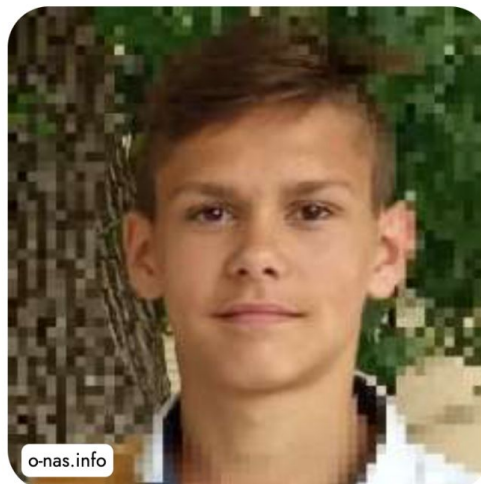
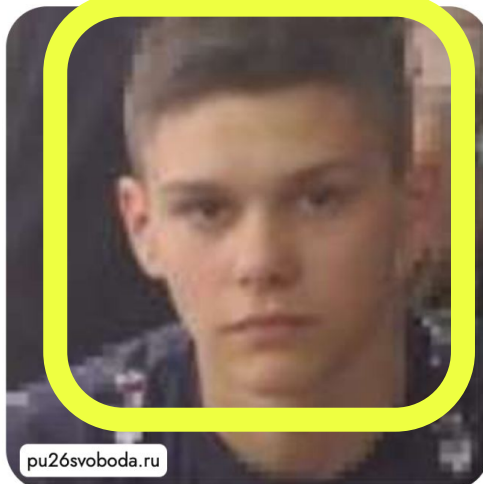
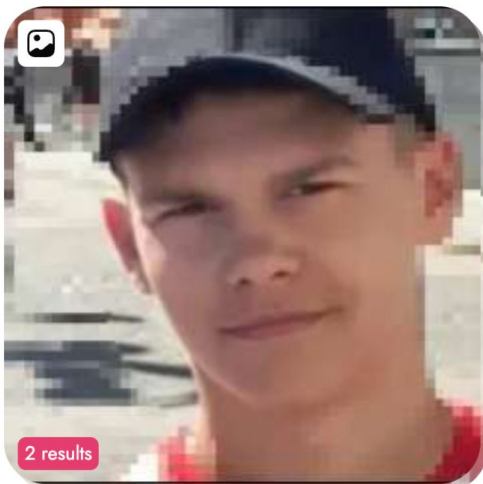
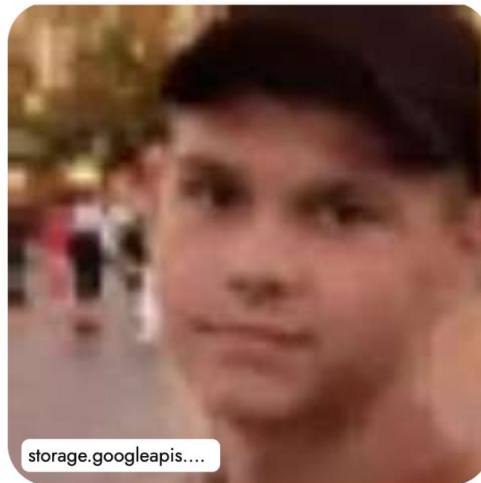
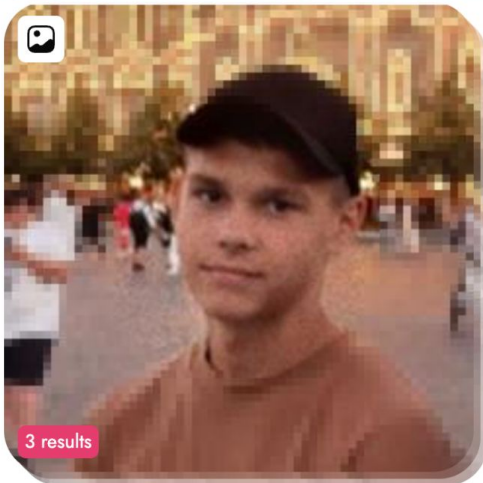
Premium Search
About 21 results in 1.79s



New Search



Generate report



The guys from the DPR received professions

Today, March 30, 26 students from the Donetsk Electromechanical Technical School completed their vocational training programs at the K.K. Rokossovsky State Technical University.

The students successfully passed the qualifying exam and were awarded certificates of qualification today:

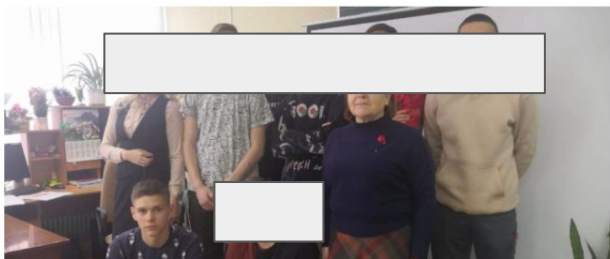
26527 Social worker – 8 people trained,

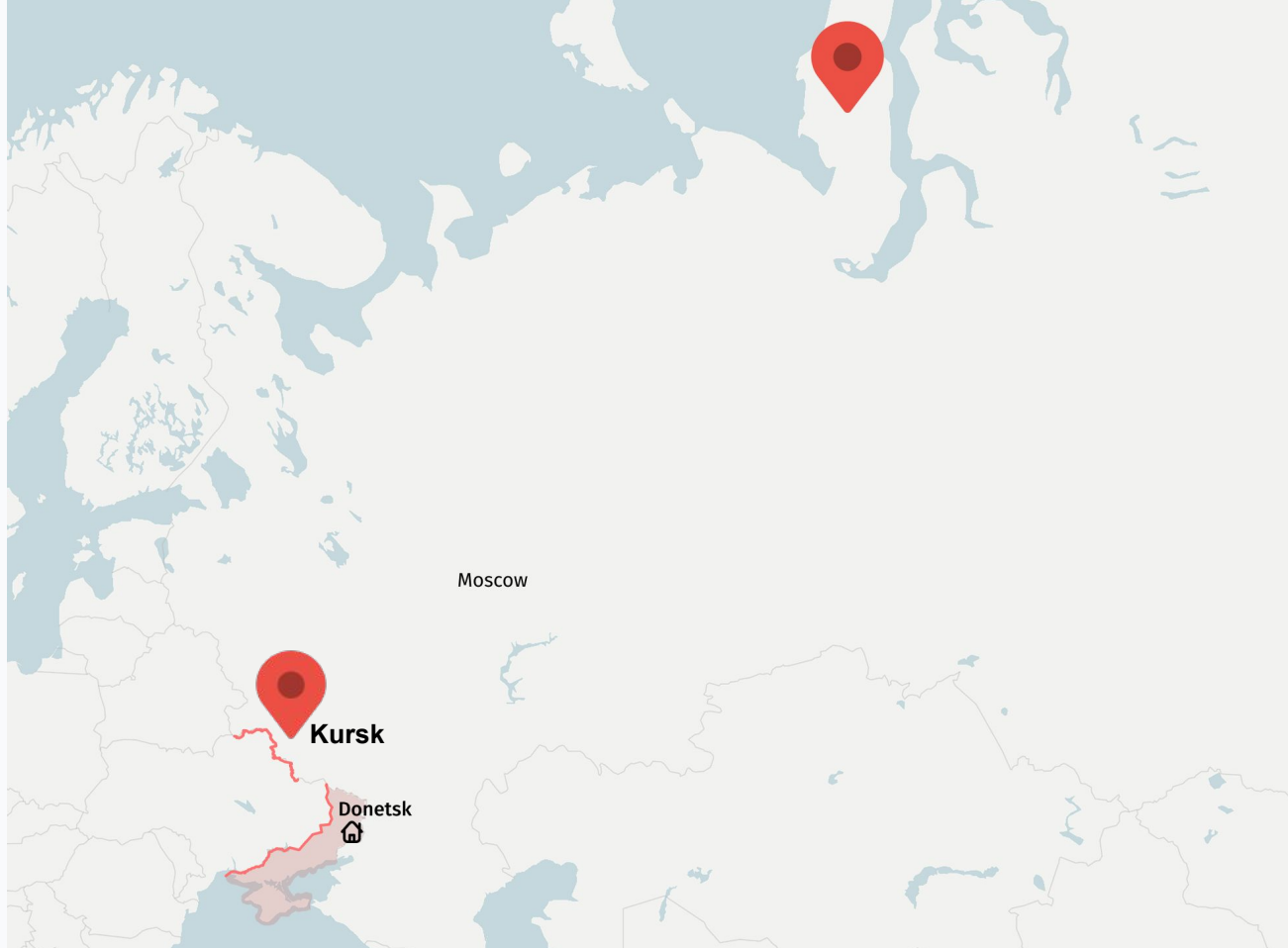
06.044 Consultant in the field of development of digital literacy of the population - 12 people were trained,

40.00200.01 Welder of arc welding with a consumable coated electrode - 6 people trained

Good emotions, smiles, and, most importantly, hope for the future permeated the certificate presentation ceremony. In addition to receiving an official certificate of completion, the students from the DPR received the warmth of our teachers, which will surely leave a lasting impression on the young people.

Training will continue, but in other professions, and will resume on April 1, 2022.





OSINT 101

facial recognition →

[search4faces](#)

Profile photos of the social network Vkontakte

Total faces: 1,113,850,873 (processed 100%).
Data collection period: Nov 2019 - Nov 2020, Dec 2022 - Jan 2023.
The percentage of successful searches: 68.79%.

Upload



Source

VK.COM - profile photos [change](#)

Gender

Not specified

Country

Not specified

Results

50

Age

0 115

City

not specified

Search

OSINT 101

facial recognition → social media → name + date of birth (?) →

search4faces



Profile photos of the social network V Kontakte

Total faces: 1,113,850,873 (processed 100%).

Data collection period: Nov 2019 - Nov 2020, Dec 2022 - Jan 2023.

The percentage of successful searches: 68.79%.

Upload



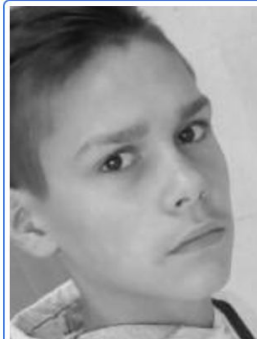
Артур Волков

score: 53.50%

22 years [7.2.2004]

[Link to profile](#)

[Photo](#)



Артур Зайцев

score: 50.31%

21 years [7.2.2005]

Russia

[Link to profile](#)

[Photo](#)

15

h

OSINT 101

facial recognition → social media → name + date of birth (?) →

search4faces



phone number/email → more leaked data



Андреевич

30.09.

20:03 ✓

Андреевич

Actions with the report ⋮

Download the report ⬇ ⋮

Andreevich

Date of birth: 30.09.1980

, Nikolaev, Ukraine

Brief summary

Passport

Cars

BT7163SR 28.57%
BT8606VN 19.05%
BT9873SV 14.29%
BT3388BX 14.29%
H721AM184 9.52%
BT5162VA 9.52%
BT7839BT 4.76%

SNILS

Taxpayer Identification Number (INN)

Driver's license

Дата	<i>from</i> Откуда	<i>to</i> Куда	Номер рейса
2022-02-19	РОССИЯ <i>russia</i> МАТВЕЕВ КУРГАН	РОССИЯ МАТВЕЕВ КУРГАН	-

matches the location of the boarding school in Donetsk region





Work in Donetsk and Mak...

For publications, please wr...

100,477 subscribers

Sign up

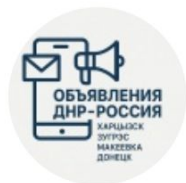


GKOU Makeyevskaya boa...

Public page

458 followers

Sign up



DPR Announcements - K...

We work for you!

24,045 subscribers

Sign up

Artur follows the page of a boarding school in Donetsk region

OSINT 101

facial recognition → social media → name + date of birth (?) →

search4faces



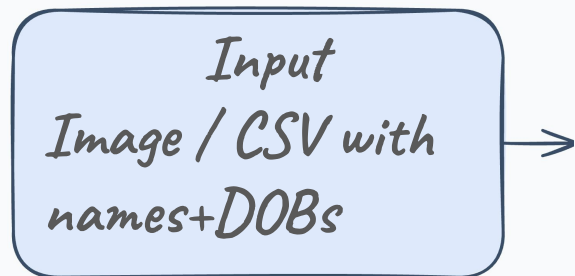
phone number/email → more leaked data



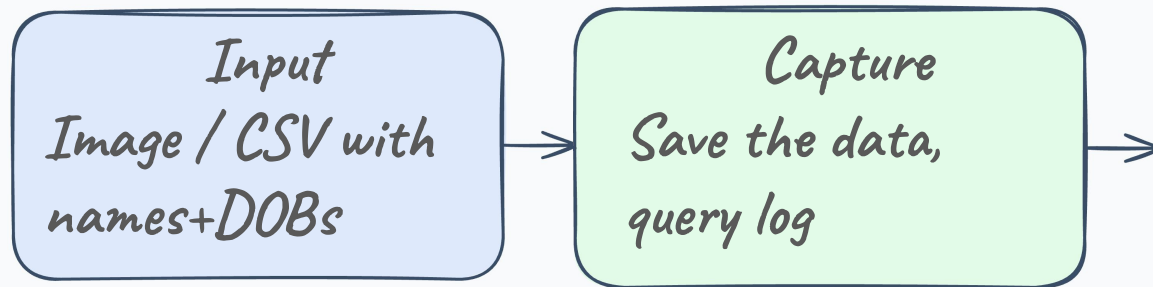
Everything x26!

AI-Assisted OSINT: Automating the investigative workflow

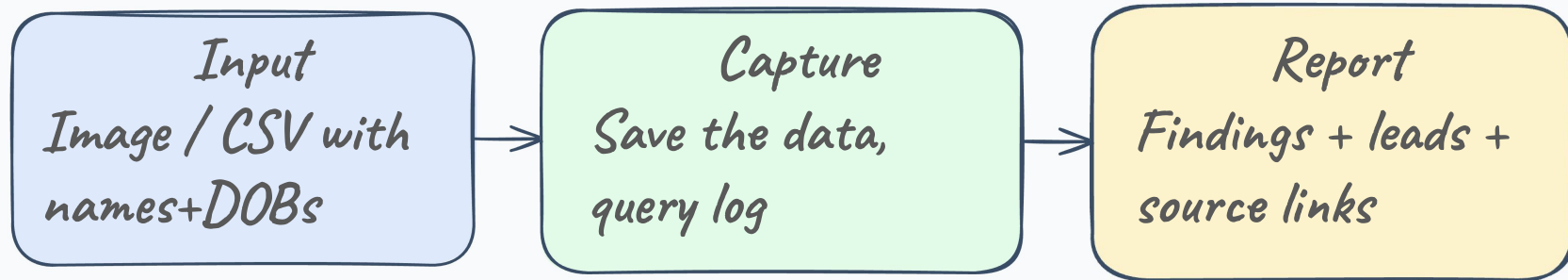
Investigation Pipeline



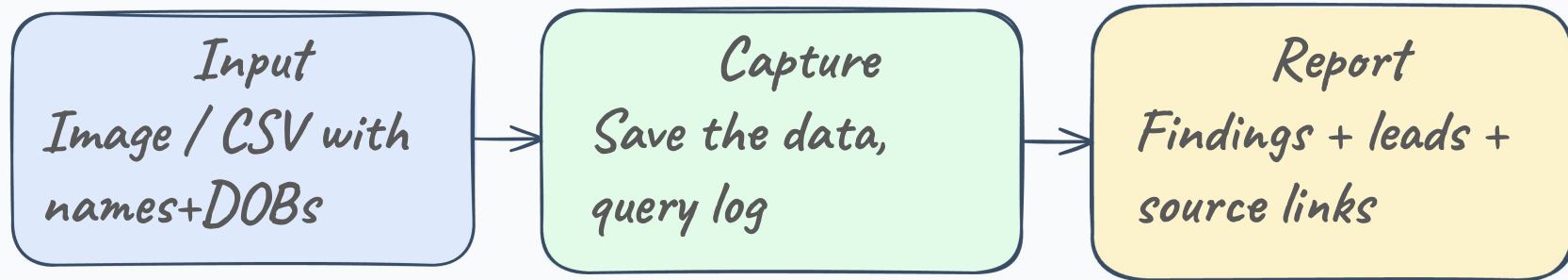
Investigation Pipeline



Investigation Pipeline

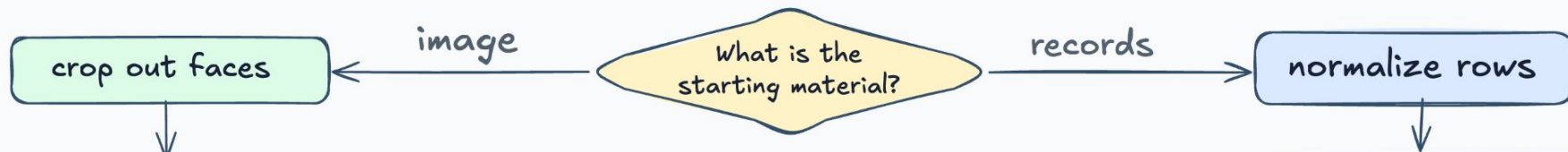


Investigation Pipeline



*The automation should answer: What do we know? How do we know it?
What remains uncertain? What is eligible next?*

Reusable Decision Tree

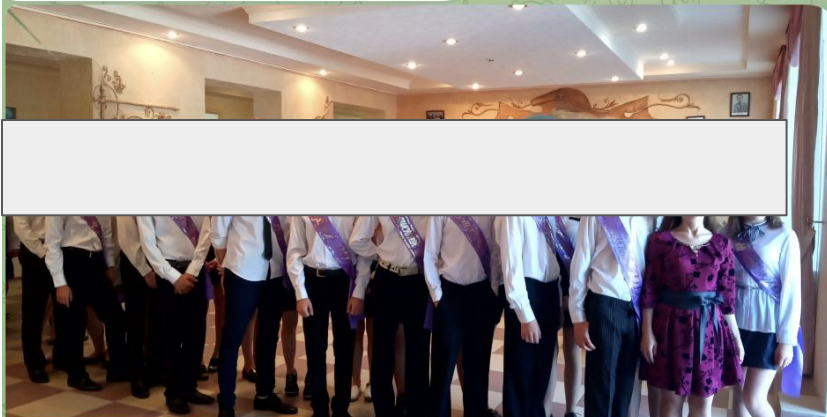


Поиск... Пожалуйста подождите, это займет не больше минут...

22:40

✓ Найдено 50 совпадений.

22:40



Сходство 52.52%

Макеевка(Украина)

<https://vk.com/id465185616>

22:40



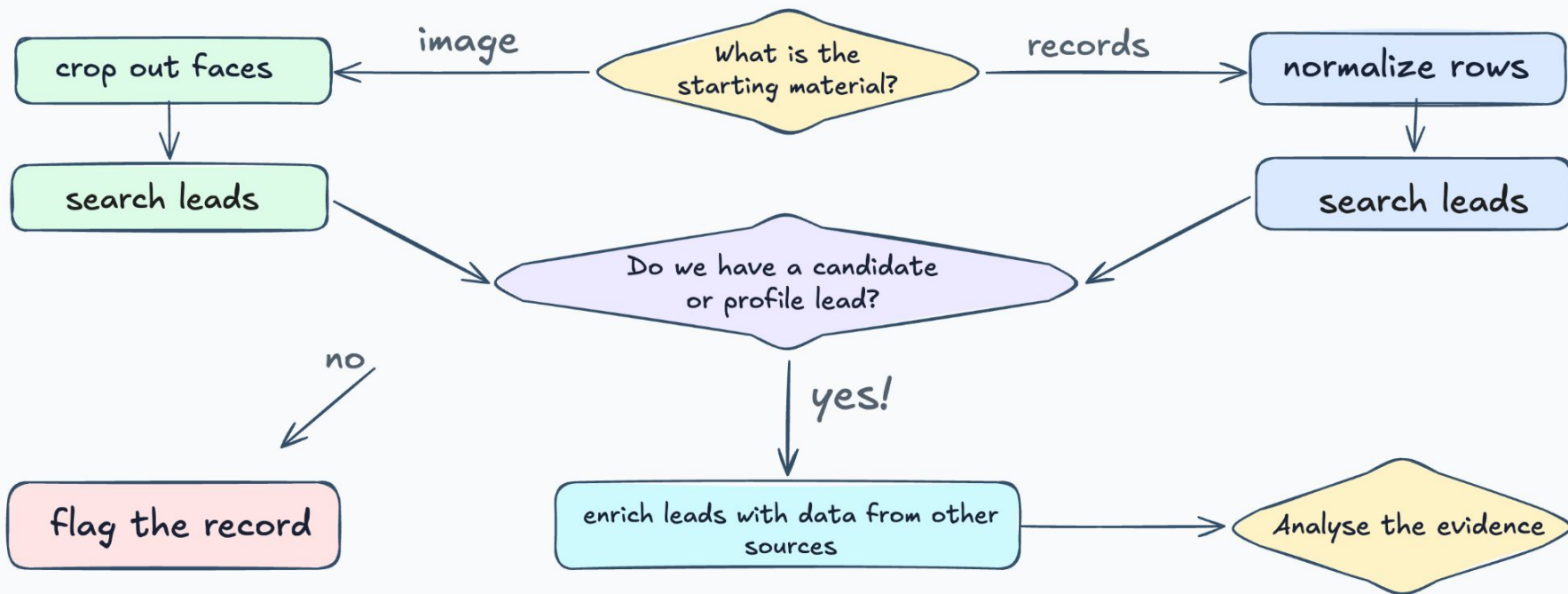
1/50



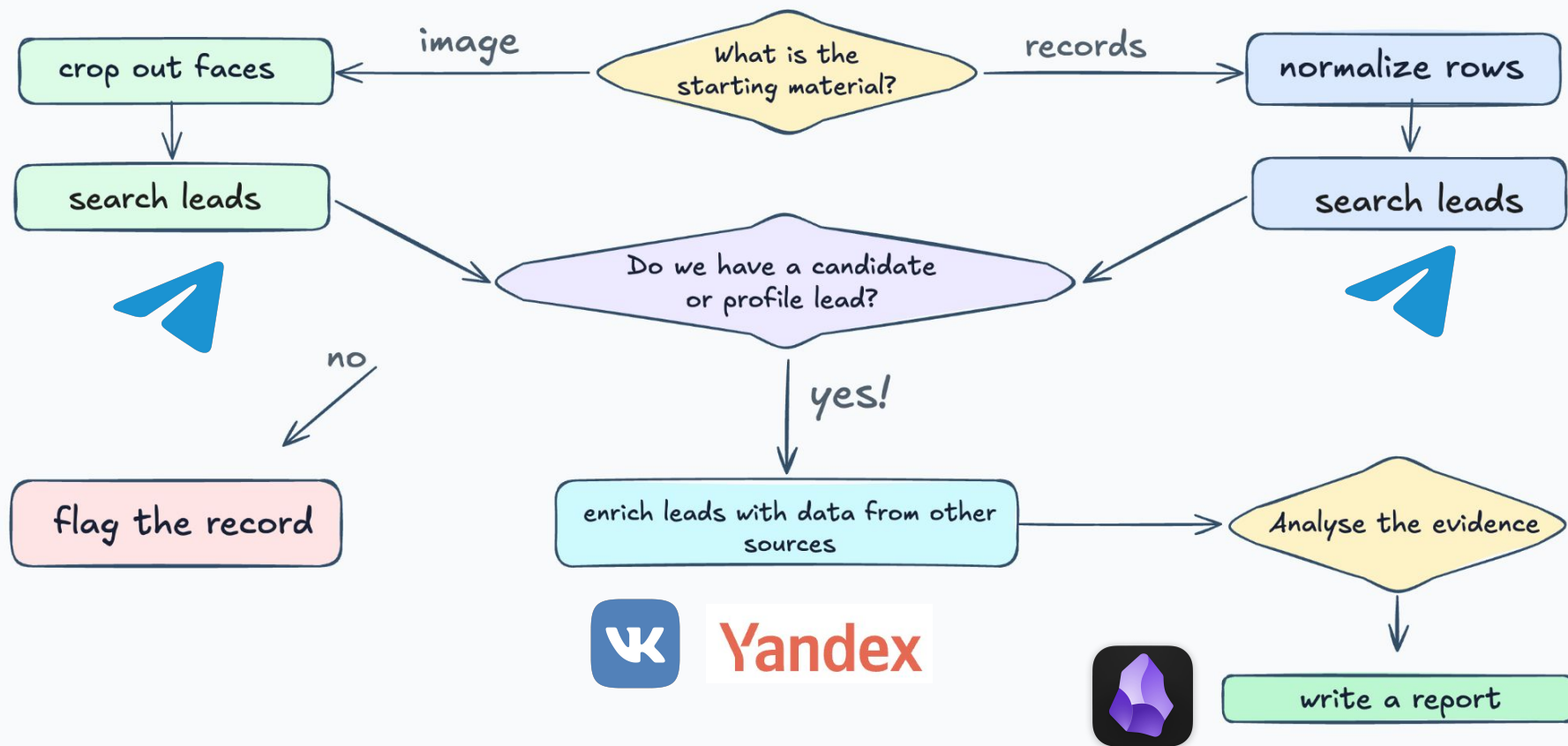
Reusable Decision Tree



Reusable Decision Tree



Reusable Decision Tree



files

- > .obsidian
- > children_of_war
- > kursk
- > osint_kit_lab
- > skills
- ⚙ .env ↗
- ↓ AGENTS.md
- ↓ INVESTIGATION_PLA...

code

conversation

prompts

Critical Markdown Files

AGENTS.md

Defines the global order of operations, evidence rules, folder boundaries.

what is this all about??

1

```
> .obsidian
> children_of_war
> kursk
> osint_kit_lab
> skills
⚙ .env
⬇ AGENTS.md
⬇ INVESTIGATION_PLA...
```



*names of your
case folders

Critical

AGENTS.m

```
↓ AGENTS.md > abc # Agent Instructions > abc ## Active Case Selection
1  # Agent Instructions
2
3  This workspace is for building reusable investigation automation and applying it to case folders.
4
5  ## Start Here
6
7  1. Read `INVESTIGATION_PLAYBOOK.md` to understand the reusable workflow and available skills.
8  2. Read the active case's `CASE.md` before running any case-specific work.
9  3. Use `skills/orchestrator` to inspect case state and queues before choosing the next skill
   when saved artifacts already exist.
10 4. Keep reusable automation in `skills/`.
11 5. Keep source material, outputs, evidence, searches, and reports inside the relevant case
   folder.
12
13 ## Evidence Rules
14
15 - Preserve source trails for every finding: source, query or input, timestamp, output path, and
   notes.
16 - Make evidence and report file references clickable in Obsidian. Use relative Markdown links
   from the note/report location, for example `[raw report](searches/sherlock_name/example_sherlock.
   txt)`, instead of plain backticked paths when referring to local case artifacts.
17 - Treat face matches, search results, and profile matches as leads until corroborated.
18 - Prefer structured outputs such as CSV or JSON over free-form notes
19 - Do not place credentials, tokens, bot sessions, or API keys in case folders or committed
   files. Use environment variables or local ignored files.
20
21 ## Folder Rules
22
23 - Reusable skills belong under `skills/<skill-name>/`.
24 - Case-specific instructions belong in `<case>/CASE.md`.
25 - Case outputs stay inside that case folder.
26 - Reports should be generated from saved evidence records, not from memory.
27
28 ## Active Case Selection
29
```

rules, folder boundaries.

Critical Markdown Files

AGENTS.md

Defines the global order of operations, evidence rules, folder boundaries.

INVESTIGATION_PLAYBOOK.md

Defines reusable workflow theory, skill catalog, default sequence, storage model.

*what is the logic and
what are my skills??
(the decision tree)*

1
2

```
> .obsidian
> children_of_war
> kursk
> osint_kit_lab
> skills
⚙ .env
⬇ AGENTS.md
⬇ INVESTIGATION_PLA...
```



*names of your
case folders

Critical

AGENTS.

INVESTIGATION

```
↓ INVESTIGATION_PLAYBOOK.md > abc # Investigation Playbook > abc ## Reusable Skills > ab
1  # Investigation Playbook
2
3  This playbook defines the reusable workflow for OSINT-style
   investigation automation in this workspace.
4
5  ## Core Principle
6
7  The system should behave like an auditable investigation pipeline:
   skills collect or transform evidence, the orchestrator decides the next
   step, and reports explain both findings and uncertainty.
8
9  AI may help choose searches, extract entities, summarize pages, and
   draft reports. It should not silently confirm identity or erase
   uncertainty.
10
11 ## Reusable Skills
12
13 ### `skills/face-extractor`
14
15 Use when a case starts from images and needs individual face crops for
   downstream search.
16
17 Input:
```

boundaries.

prage model.

AGENTS.md

Defines the global order of operations, evidence rules, folder boundaries.

INVESTIGATION_PLAYBOOK.md

Defines reusable workflow theory, skill catalog, default sequence, storage model.

skills//SKILL.md*

Defines when a skill is valid, expected inputs, outputs, operational notes.

```
> .obsidian
> children_of_war
> kursk
> osint_kit_lab
> skills
```



```
.env
```



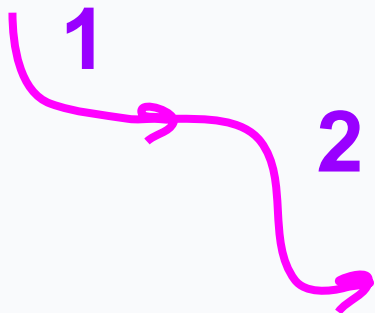
```
AGENTS.md
```

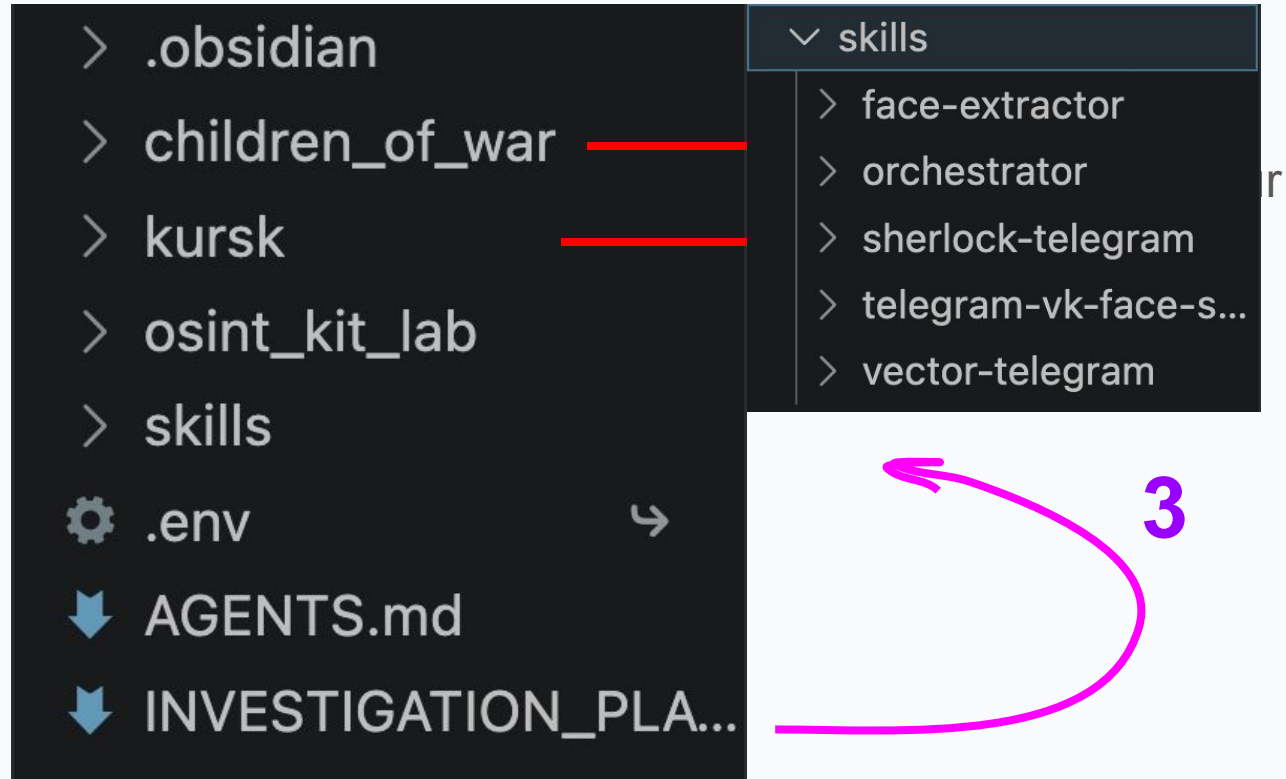


```
INVESTIGATION_PLA...
```



*names of your
case folders





✓ skills

✓ face-extractor

✓ scripts

skills > face-extractor > ⚡ SKILL.md > ...

1 ---

2 **name:** face-extractor

3 **description:** Extracts individual faces from case images using
InsightFace RetinaFace and writes rectangular PNG crops plus a simple
manifest.

what is this skill about??

✓ skills

✓ face-extractor

✓ scripts

skills > face-extractor > ⚡ SKILL.md > ...

1 ---

2 name: face-extractor

3 description: Extracts individual faces from case images using
InsightFace RetinaFace and writes rectangular PNG crops plus a simple
manifest.

what is this skill about?? → can it be useful now?

✓ skills

✓ face-extractor

✓ scripts

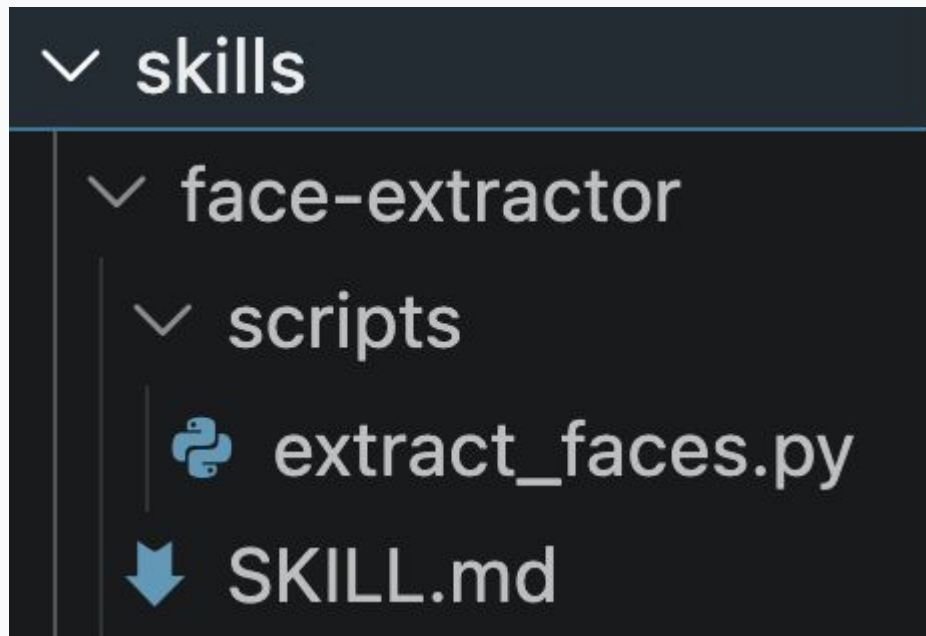
skills > face-extractor > ⚡ SKILL.md > ...

1 ---

2 **name:** face-extractor

3 **description:** Extracts individual faces from case images using
InsightFace RetinaFace and writes rectangular PNG crops plus a simple
manifest.

*what is this skill about?? → can it be useful now? → ok,
how to actually use it?!*



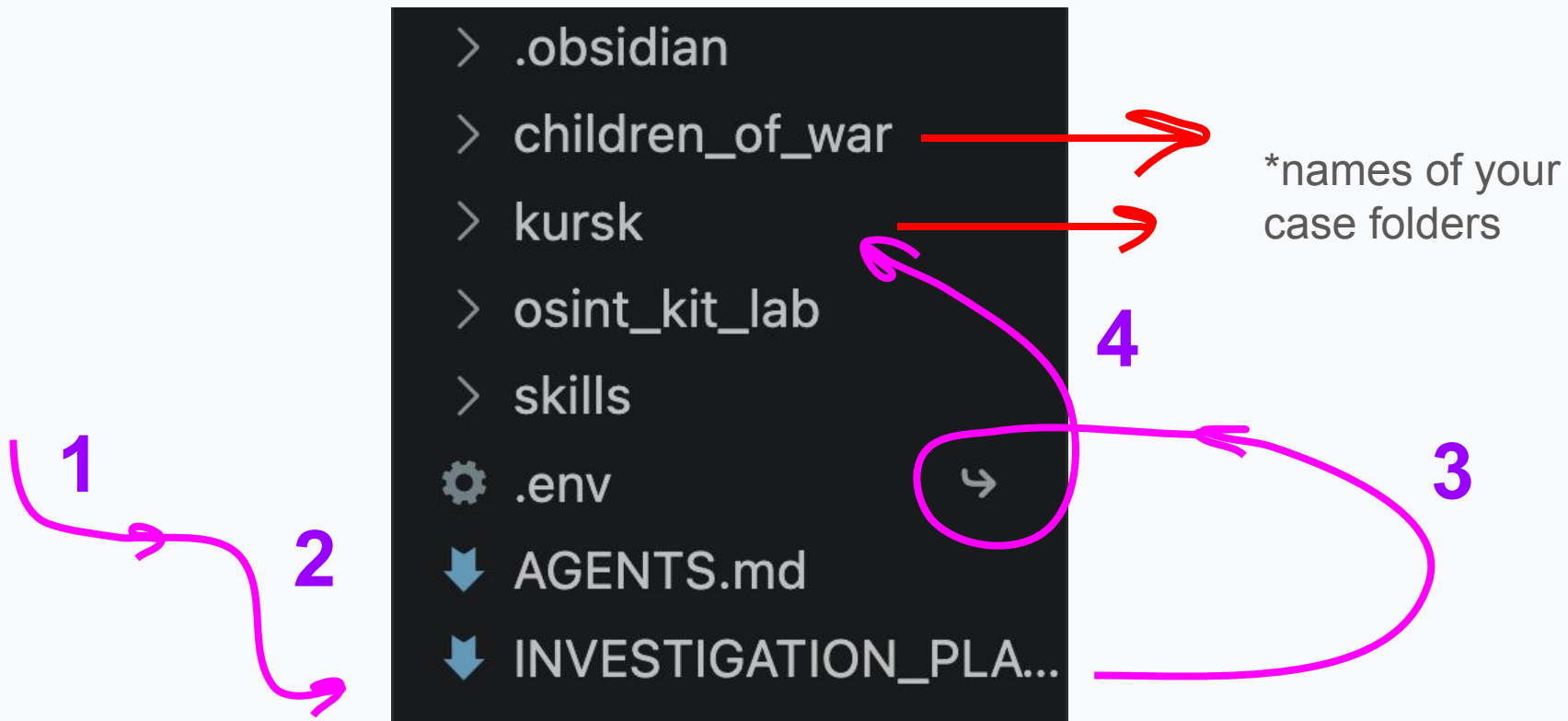
*what is this skill about?? → can it be useful now? → ok,
how to actually use it?! —————→*

skills > orchestrator >  SKILL.md > ...

1 ---

2 **name:** orchestrator

3 **description:** Deterministic state-machine
orchestrator for case folders. Reads
existing investigation artifacts, decides
current workflow state, writes candidate
and queue files, and creates an auditable
run report without calling external
services.



AGENTS.md

Defines the global order of operations, evidence rules, folder boundaries.

INVESTIGATION_PLAYBOOK.md

Defines reusable workflow theory, skill catalog, default sequence, storage model.

skills//SKILL.md*

Defines when a skill is valid, expected inputs, outputs, operational notes.

<case>/CASE.md

Defines the case goal, source inputs, allowed workflow, current status.

anything specific about what we're gonna investigate now??

Case Goal

Start from the images in `kursk/pictures/` , extract individual face crops, use Telegram/VK-style face-search leads, expand candidate information with targeted `SerpAPI` dork searches, score the evidence, and generate a report.

Source Inputs

- `kursk/pictures/` contains the original images for this case.
- Source images should remain unchanged.

CHILDREN OF WAR

February 24, 2022 - May 29, 2026

[Children of War](#) / **Children**

MAZUROV VLADISLAV VADYMOVYCH

04/26/2007

MARCHENKO OLEKSANDR ANATOLIYOVYCH

01/19/2011

VOLVACH MYKYTA ANDRIYOVYCH

10/26/2004

ZAGATSKYY BOHDAN RUSLANOVYCH

01/21/2014

DEGTYROVA ANASTASIA VASILIVNA

12.07.2014

GORKUN OLEKSANDR OLEKSANDROVYCH

06/24/2014

MELNYCHENKO HANNA YURIEVNA

08.10.2009

AI

Skills

Helps choose searches, refines the data

Collect and transform evidence

Summarizes and drafts reports

The orchestrator skill routes next steps

 flagged.csv

≡ Айвазян_7933506...

≡ Айвазян_Давид_А...

≡ Алипов_Александр...

≡ Анисимов_793316...

≡ Анисимов_799000...

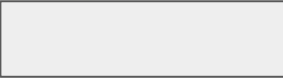
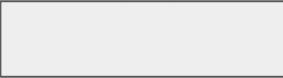
≡ Анисимов_Михаил...

≡ Бабуров_7995614...

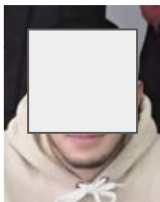
≡ Бабуров_Станисла...

<> Беклемищев_Дан...

✓ Гисмат Горловский

- VK: <https://vk.com/id407940972>
- Face-search label: 
- Sherlock VK name: 
- Sherlock VK DOB: 
- Phone-confirmed n: 
- Phone-confirmed D: 
- Profile-linked phon: 
- Match statuses: dob_conflict, profile_exact_vk_id_and_dob, sparse
- Profile-linked: yes
- Lead count: 89
- Vector-ready: no
- Phone report:  [k.txt](#)
- Phone report:  [.txt](#)

face_015 - 62.54%



AI-generated report on patterns across the leads

The reviewed group appears to follow a shared movement and documentation pattern. All identified individuals were born between 2003 and 2005, and the available border-crossing records indicate the same departure date: 2022-02-19.

Most records include Russian phone numbers, while a smaller number still reference Ukrainian numbers. VK profile data also shows a recurring geographic signal: most profiles list, or previously listed, Makeevka as the associated city.

The records also indicate that all reviewed individuals have Russian passport data. Taken together, the shared birth range, synchronized departure date, recurring Makeevka profile location, and Russian documentation suggest a coherent group-level pattern rather than isolated individual records.

~~Problems~~

Challenges!

~~Problems~~

Challenges!

1. AI providers don't trust your good intentions

This content was flagged for possible cybersecurity risk. If this seems wrong, try rephrasing your request. To get authorized for security work, join the Trusted Access for Cyber program:
<https://chatgpt.com/cyber>

1 file changed

Undo ↶

Review ↗



...herlock-telegram/scripts/sherlock_phone_links.py +26 -0 ▾

continue



~~Problems~~

Challenges!

1. AI providers don't trust your good intentions
2. People lie on social media

Profile photos of the social network Vkontakte

Total faces: 1,113,850,873 (processed 100%).

Data collection period: Nov 2019 - Nov 2020, Dec 2022 - Jan 2023.

The percentage of successful searches: 68.79%.

Upload





Артур Волков

score: 53.50%

22 years [7.2.2004]

Artur Wolf

[Link to profile](#) [Photo](#)



Артур Зайцев

score: 50.31%

21 years [7.2.2005]

Artur Hare

Russia

[Link to profile](#) [Photo](#)

~~Problems~~

Challenges!

1. AI providers don't trust your good intentions
2. People lie on social media
3. Automation can scale mistakes very quickly

~~Problems~~

Challenges!

1. AI providers don't trust your good intentions
2. People lie on social media
3. Automation can scale mistakes very quickly
4. Some tools hate automation (Pimeyes)

Lessons learned!

1. Don't name your dataset 'children of war', 'kill list', or 'my enemies'
2. Write as you go
3. Make every skill runnable on its own
4. Raw outputs first, beautiful reports later
5. "No result" is still a result. Save it

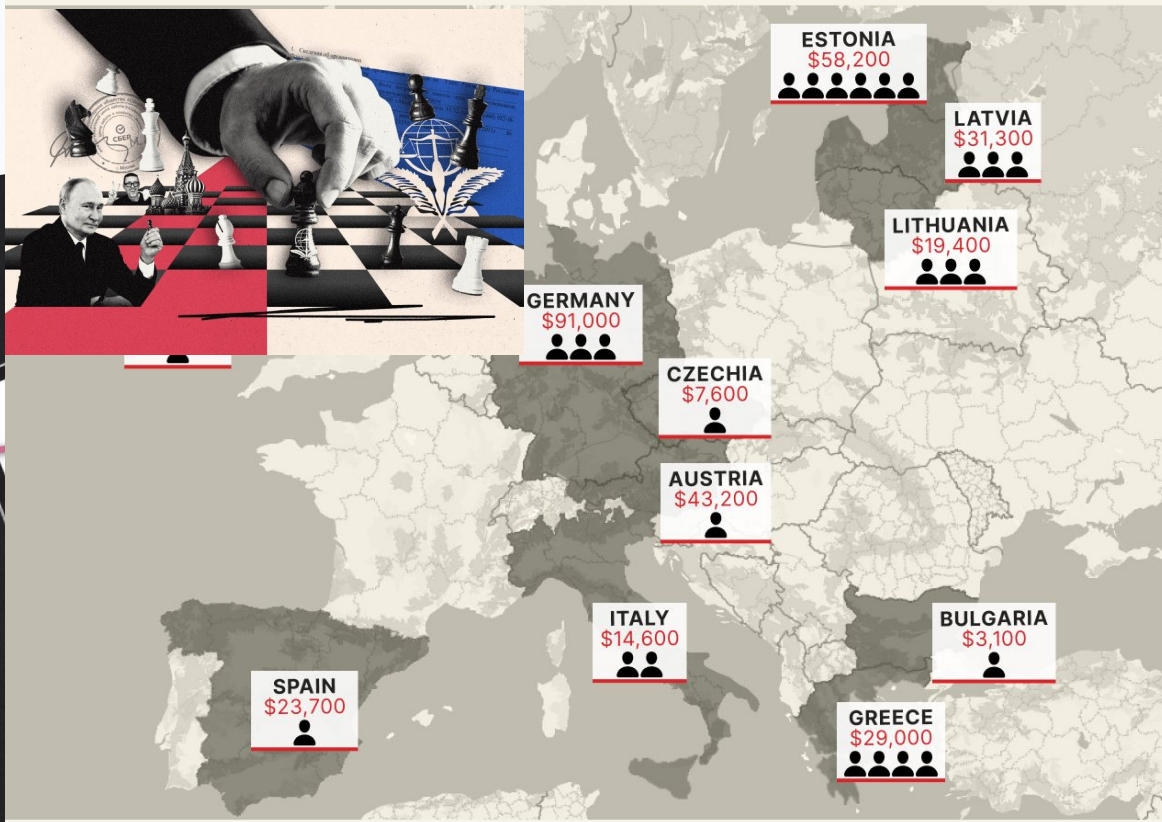
Old investigations where automation could have been useful



Old investigations where automation could be useful



EU Countries Where Pravfond Sent Money After Being Sanctioned



Data from contracts found in Pravfond emails

d be useful

European style!



HANDS-ON PART

<https://bit.ly/pydantic-osint-colab>

<https://bit.ly/osint-keys>

We're going to look at a **simple source-aware OSINT agent** that:

- checks a company in a business registry
- runs web searches around the company and related people
- saves the evidence it collects
- writes a short report

In the Colab notebook:

- each cell is a compact version of the larger files shown in the presentation
- each code cell includes a prompt you could give to AI to generate similar code

This pipeline is useful for an initial company check. It is not deep investigative research. Its goal is to collect basic registry and public-source information that can help you decide whether a company is a potential lead worth investigating further.

We're going to look at a **simple source-aware OSINT agent** that:

- checks a company in a business registry
- runs web searches around the company and related people
- saves the evidence it collects
- writes a short report

In the Colab notebook:

- each cell is a compact version of the larger files shown in the presentation
- each code cell includes a prompt you could give to AI to generate similar code

This pipeline is useful for an initial company check. It is not deep investigative research. Its goal is to collect basic registry and public-source information that can help you decide whether a company is a potential lead worth investigating further.

We're going to look at a **simple source-aware OSINT agent** that:

- checks a company in a business registry
- runs web searches around the company and related people
- saves the evidence it collects
- writes a short report

In the Colab notebook:

- each cell is a compact version of the larger files shown in the presentation
- each code cell includes a prompt you could give to AI to generate similar code

This pipeline is useful for an initial company check. It is not deep investigative research.

Its goal is to collect basic registry and public-source information that can help you

decide whether a company is a potential lead worth investigating further.

What are we going to use?



global investigative platform that uses open-source data to help journalists uncover hidden connections and detect risks across multiple jurisdictions

Free for journalists!

<https://id.youcontrol.world/registration/journalists-media>

What are we going to use?



OCCRP

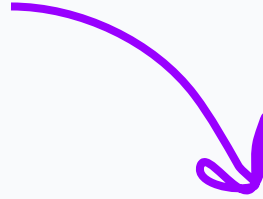


pydantic-ai
a Python framework
for building agents

Codex/Claude Code VS Pydantic AI



interactive help



reusable workflow

```
import random
```

```
from pydantic_ai import Agent, RunContext
```

```
agent = Agent(  
    "gateway/gemini-3-pro-preview",  
    deps_type=str,  
    system_prompt=(  
        "You're a dice game, you should roll the die and see if the number "  
        "you get back matches the user's guess. If so, tell them they're a winner. "  
        "Use the player's name in the response."  
    ),  
)
```

Anastasiia Morozova

data+investigations

nst.morozova13@gmail.com

<https://anastasiiamorozova.github.io/website/>